

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 865

By Vital

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Carl Edward Tallant of Ooltewah.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Carl Edward Tallant; and

WHEREAS, Carl Edward Tallant passed away on August 22, 2025, at 11:22 p.m. in Ooltewah; known affectionately as "Mr. Ooltewah," he was a local pharmacist and a fourth-generation Tennessean with deep roots in the Ooltewah and Collegedale communities; and

WHEREAS, born on January 14, 1936, Mr. Tallant was the son of Carl Hinkle Tallant and Cena Marie Robinson; the Tallants had settled at the foot of Grindstone Mountain, including the land around present-day Tallant Road in Collegedale, and the Robinsons had farmland that stretched from the Ooltewah Four Corners to beyond Cambridge Square; and

WHEREAS, Carl Ed Tallant grew up in Ooltewah and attended Ooltewah Elementary School and Ooltewah High School, graduating in 1955; he gained a reputation for playing "hooky" from school, sneaking a ride on the milk truck back home or to Tallant Drug Company on Main Street, where his father served as the druggist for the area; and

WHEREAS, after high school, he attended Oglethorpe University in Atlanta, Georgia; after a time of visiting his high school sweetheart, Mary Catherine Bates, every Sunday via train, he decided to be closer to her by enrolling in the University of Chattanooga, from which he ultimately graduated; and

WHEREAS, Carl Ed Tallant and Mary Bates were married on June 8, 1958, and made their home in a brick ranch on fifteen acres of the original Robinson family farm; Mr. Tallant followed in his father's footsteps and ran Tallant Drug Company, while Mrs. Tallant worked as a medical technologist at Erlanger Hospital; and

WHEREAS, he spent many years bringing joy to children and adults with the ice cold Mayfield ice cream cones he personally dipped for the customers at only fifteen cents each; when Tallant Drug closed, he worked for many other pharmacies including Protocare, a state-of-the-art infusion therapy company from which he eventually retired; and

WHEREAS, a man of deep faith, Mr. Tallant was a member of Ooltewah Baptist Church and, later, Ridgedale Baptist Church; he served in various positions over the years, including Sunday School director, treasurer, and door greeter; and

WHEREAS, he greatly enjoyed traveling with his family and was happiest when he was partaking in life's simple pleasures, including mowing grass, bush hogging, or planting a vegetable garden, the bounty of which he generously shared with his friends and neighbors; and

WHEREAS, above all, he was wholly devoted to his family, especially his grandchildren; he loved attending their school functions and sporting events and teaching them how to tend the land and grow their own food; and

WHEREAS, Carl Ed Tallant will be sadly mourned yet fondly remembered by his two loving daughters, Mary Jane Tallant Fitzgerald and Carla Jean Tallant (Kent) McCrary; his three beloved grandchildren, Walker Fitzgerald, Cole McCrary, and Kailey McCrary; a special cousin, Eddie Robinson; and a host of extended family and friends; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, he was preceded in death by his dear wife, Mary Catherine Bates Tallant; son-in-law, Dale Coe Fitzgerald; and sister, Rose Marie Tallant-Gilreath; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Tallant will be remembered for his affable nature, good humor, and generosity, as well as his many stories of the Ooltewah community, which he dearly loved; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Carl Edward Tallant, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Tallant.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.